INDIA GCC ECOSYSTEM

One source of truth for India's 2,000+ Global Capability Centres

Strategy deck and working prototype

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QUESTION 1 OF 4

The problem: entrants decide blind, and nobody holds the full picture

Who is hurt

Seven players. Entrants carry the most cost, and the other six are hurt less.

How much

About $0.7–1.4B a year of incentive value in play. An order of magnitude, to be tested.

What they do today

Referrals, consultant PDFs, events, cold outreach and brochures.

Solution. One sourced view where every fact shows its source and how far to trust it.

QUESTION 2 OF 4

The opportunities: two matter most

Build first: registry and pipeline

Scarce, feeds every other product, and gets stronger with every user.

Build first: provider track records

The trust gap. Proof of delivery beats marketing, and providers will pay for it.

Ship early: city comparator

The hook for entrants, built mostly on public data.

Solution. Start with the two scarce assets. Office-space and talent data come later. Our scores are judgement, to be tested in interviews.

QUESTION 3 OF 4

The solution: GCC Atlas, an evidence-linked graph

1 · Collect

Filings, state policies, press, job posts and provider case studies.

2 · Resolve

AI extracts facts with the quote it used. Every fact keeps its source and a confidence label.

3 · Serve

Registry, city comparator, provider scorecards and pipeline alerts.

For whom first. The entrant's India setup lead, free. First revenue comes from providers, who pay for verified profiles and pipeline alerts.

QUESTION 4 OF 4

The positioning: evidence, not advertising

Entrants

One comparable, sourced view instead of referrals.

Providers

Ranked on delivery, plus qualified leads.

States

Compared on facts, with a way to keep data current.

Analysts and media

A citable, canonical list instead of conflicting reports.

Positioning. The neutral reference layer for India's GCC ecosystem. Every number links to its source, and nobody pays to rank.

A long chain of players, none with the full picture



Each handoff loses information. The ? marks where counts, incentives and delivery records go missing.

No agreed count

Reports quote different totals, and none publishes the list of companies behind them.

Delivery is invisible

Providers are known by their marketing. Who actually delivered is not on record.

Referrals fill the gap

Entrants pick cities and partners on word of mouth, and pay for it in time and risk.

Who is hurt, and what they do today

Our judgement, to be tested in interviews. Entrants carry the biggest cost, so we build for them first.

PLAYER	HURT	HOW THE ASYMMETRY HURTS	WHAT THEY DO TODAY
Entrant HQ	High	Picks city and partners blind	Referrals, consultant PDFs
Advisors	Medium	Cannot show proof of delivery	Events, case-study decks
Lawyers and auditors	Medium	Cannot see who is about to enter	Cold outreach, referrals
Real estate firms	Medium	Miss entrants before they pick a city	Broker networks, press scanning
Recruiters	Medium	Learn hiring plans too late	LinkedIn mining, job-board alerts
Payroll and EOR	Medium	Compete on price, not on record	Partner lists, word of mouth
State governments	Medium	Offers cannot be compared on facts	Roadshows, brochures

The numbers, and why they conflict

2,117
GCCs, FY26

3,728
GCC units

2.36M
people employed

$98.4B
revenue, FY26

Older reports said 1,600+ GCCs. FY24 estimates said about 1,700–1,800. FY26 says 2,117 companies and 3,728 units. Different years and different units, quoted side by side.

Sources: nasscom–Zinnov India GCC Landscape 2026; BW Businessworld; Business of GCC; Sridhar Pai Tonse (Substack).

How much is at stake: roughly $1B a year

~100

new GCCs a year

500+ in five years (nasscom–Zinnov)

×

$46M

average revenue per GCC

$98.4B ÷ 2,117 GCCs (derived)

×

15–30%

of cost from incentives

One source, unverified

=

$0.7–1.4B

a year in play

Order of magnitude only

Averages overstate new centres, which start smaller. Treat this as an order of magnitude.

Not counted: months lost choosing a city, wrong partner choices, and providers' cost of finding leads.

Next step: test these inputs in about ten entrant interviews.

Five opportunities, scored. Two matter most.

Our judgement, to be tested in interviews. H is high, M medium, L low.

#	OPPORTUNITY	PAIN	WHO PAYS	DATA ACCESS	HARD TO COPY	CALL
1	Verified GCC registry and pipeline	H	Providers	M	H	Build first
2	Provider track records	H	Providers	L	H	Build first
3	City and incentive comparator	H	Entrants (free)	H	L	Ship early
4	Office space and cluster costs	M	Real estate	L	M	Later
5	Talent supply and cost	M	Recruiters, EOR	L	M	Later

Registry and provider records matter most. They are scarce, they feed every other product, and they get stronger with every user.

GCC Atlas: an evidence-linked graph of the ecosystem

1 · Collect

Filings, state policies, press, job posts and provider case studies.

2 · Resolve

AI extracts facts with the quote it used. Every fact keeps its source and a confidence label.

3 · Serve

Registry, city comparator, provider scorecards and pipeline alerts.

First user: the entrant's India setup lead, free. First revenue: providers, who pay for the pipeline.

How it works, and what comes first

Collect and verify

Filings, state policy documents, press and job posts. AI extracts facts with the quote it relied on. People review low-confidence items. Providers are confirmed by their clients.

Version 1, first 90 days

Registry with sources and confidence. State incentive tracker linked to official documents. City comparator. Provider profiles in a small pilot.

Later

Pipeline alerts for paying providers. Office-space and talent datasets. API and reports. State-published data feeds.

Every fact keeps its source and a confidence label, so users can see how far to trust it.

What entrants use instead

ALTERNATIVE	GOOD AT	GAP
Analyst reports	Authoritative market totals	Annual and aggregate, no live company or provider list
Consultancies and advisors	Tailored setup advice	Paid engagements, so conflicted when they also sell services
Directories and data vendors	Lists of companies	Company data, not provider track records or incentives
Referrals	Trust	Does not scale and favours who you already know

Evidence, not advertising

Positioning: the neutral reference layer for India's GCC ecosystem. Every number links to its source, and nobody pays to rank.

STAKEHOLDER	USES TODAY	SWITCHES BECAUSE
Entrants	Referrals, consultant PDFs	One comparable, sourced view
Providers	Pay-to-list directories	Ranked on delivery, plus qualified leads
State governments	Roadshows, brochures	Compared on facts, with a way to keep data current
Analysts and media	Conflicting reports	A citable, canonical list

Free for entrants, paid by the ecosystem

Free for entrants

Registry, city comparator and incentive tracker. Entrants bring demand and credibility.

Paid by providers

Verified profiles built on client-confirmed delivery, plus pipeline alerts on GCCs about to set up.

Paid by data users

API and reports for analysts, investors and advisors who need a citable, canonical list.

Integrity rule: nobody pays to rank. States share data to keep incentives current, but cannot buy position. Pricing to be validated in pilots.

Risks and open questions

Data accuracy

Wrong data would end trust. Every fact shows its source and confidence, and high confidence needs an official document.

Cold start

Entrants need data before providers pay. Public data gives entrants value on day one, and providers pay once there is an audience.

Neutrality

Paying providers could tilt rankings. Nobody pays to rank, and the method is published.

Data rights

Collecting data has legal limits. Use public sources, keep quotes short, and offer a way to correct or remove. Needs legal review.

To validate: willingness to pay, how entrants really decide, and why providers would want to be verified.

The prototype, and what comes next

Working today

Sourced data with confidence labels, a policy map and a savings calculator. AI extraction from pasted articles, plain-English search and guided setup.

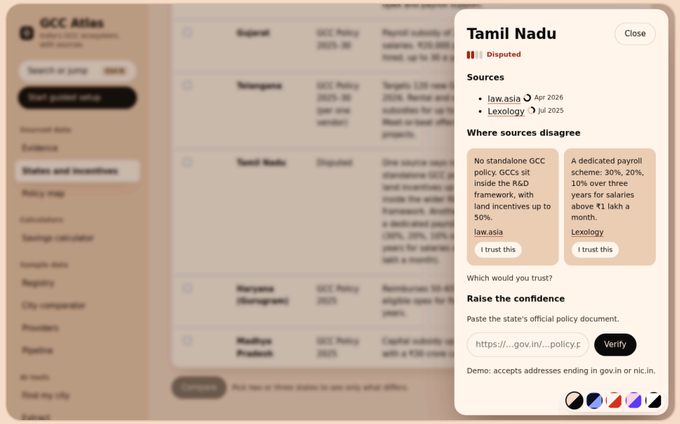
Next 90 days

Automate ingestion from public filings and press. Verify providers through client confirmation. Launch pipeline alerts for paying providers.

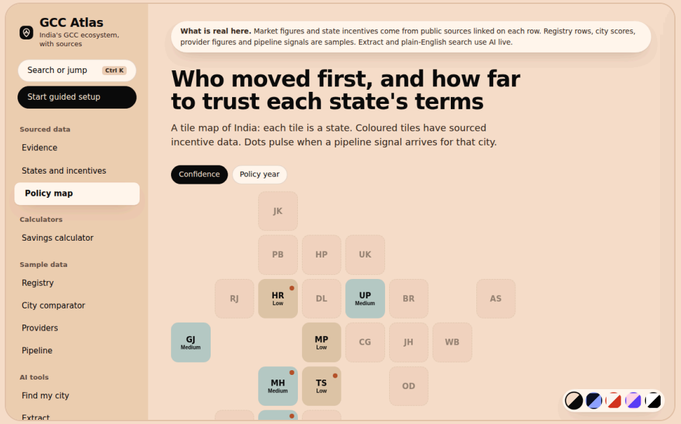
Prototype data is illustrative seed data and is labelled as such.

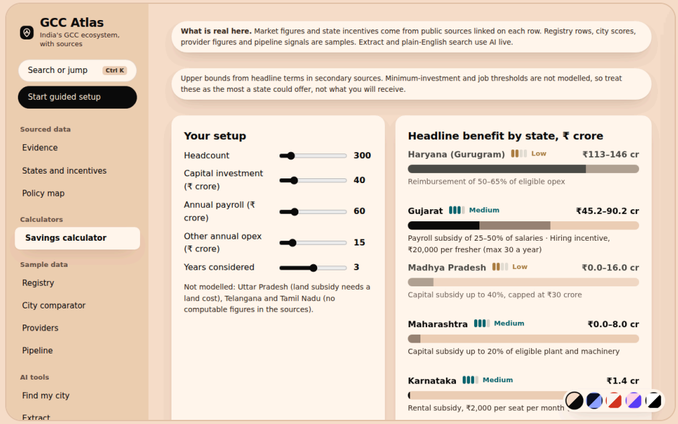
The prototype in action





Evidence where reports disagree, so you choose.





Ranges mapped to sourced figures, with confidence for each state.

The first 90 days

Days 1–30 · Foundation

Ingest the nasscom–Zinnov data, state policies and press. Link official policy documents to lift incentive rows to High confidence.

Days 31–60 · Trust

Pilot client-confirmed delivery with a small group of providers. Run entrant interviews to validate the sizing.

Days 61–90 · Revenue

Launch pipeline alerts to paying pilot providers. Publish the first citable count with its method.